

“Do you know why I’m here, Aesir?” she cried.

Odin stood up, but before he could speak Skadi had knocked an arrow and pointed it at his remaining eye.

“Choose your next words carefully,” she warned.

Odin weighed the situation and said, “Has enough blood not already been shed? Perhaps we can offer you something to keep the peace?”

*“I want you to cast my father’s eyes into the sky, so I can feel his gaze upon me,” Skadi replied.*

So Thjazi’s eyes became two stars in the night sky.

“My grief overwhelms me,” she continued. “I wish to laugh again.”

This time Loki stepped forward. He tied one end of a rope to an angry goat, and the other to his own nose-hairs. Loki and the goat pulled and strained in a protracted and painful game of tug-o-war. Eventually Loki’s nose-hairs tore free, and with a scream he tumbled into Skadi’s lap.

“I have one more demand,” Skadi said after she’d finished laughing.

“Name it,” Odin replied.

“I want to marry a god.”

